

RESOURCES FOR PRODUCT MANAGERS: THE BEST PLACE TO START

A comprehensive, curated list of
resources to help you learn and grow in
your role as a Product Manager



CONSCIOUS^o
PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

CONSCIOUS^o

PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

"Develop products that make people's lives measurably better."

Author's Note

[Lisa Zane](#), Founder of [Conscious Product Development](#)



I put this list together as a tool to help aspiring and seasoned product managers learn and grow after being asked by clients, teams I am currently mentoring, and people in my network for resource recommendations on a recurring basis.

I am always adding to this list - if you have relevant resources to suggest [please add them here](#). I hope this helps you in whatever stage of your career you are in - whether you are thinking about transitioning into product management, or you are in a leadership role. I urge you to use this as a starting point, [but to follow your instincts and continue to grow in the ways that leverage your unique super powers](#) and make you distinctly you.

Be yourself. Keep learning. Don't give up.

- Lisa

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- 👉 Are you looking for guidance after just starting in a new role?
 - 👉 Are you a seasoned Product Manager looking to improve your performance?
 - 👉 Are you looking for help through a particularly challenging situation you are facing?



[Book a 1:1 Coaching Session](#)

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Product Manager Resources

Have a relevant resource you'd like to suggest? [Submit it here.](#)

Books and Articles

Getting Started

- [Inspired: How to Create Tech Products Customers Love](#) by Marty Cagan
- [How to Become a Product Manager](#) by Brainstation (ARTICLE)
- [Product Management's Sacred Seven: The Skills Required to Crush Product Manager Interviews and be a World-Class PM](#) by Partha Detroja
- [Cracking the PM Career](#) by Jackie Bavaro and Gayle Laakmann McDowell
- [Sprint: How to Solve Big Problems and Test New Ideas in Just Five Days](#) by Jake Knapp
- [Shape Up: Stop Running in Circles and Ship Work that Matters](#) by Ryan Singer
- [The Lean Product Playbook](#) by Dan Olsen
- [The First 90 Days: Proven Strategies for Getting Up to Speed Faster and Smarter](#) by Micheal Watkins
- [How to Product](#) by Sefunmi Osinaike
- [Decode and Conquer](#) by Lewis C. Lin
- [Pivot to Product Manager](#) by Irving Malcolm
- [The Product Diploma](#) by Alan Ni and Davis Treybig
- [CEO Guide to Product](#) by Tanya Cordrey

- [The Product Book: How to Become a Great Product Manager](#) by Carlos González de Villaumbrosia and Josh Anon
- [A Playbook for Principled Decision Making](#) by Will Lawrence/Product Life
- [Define Your Career North Star as a Product Manager](#) by Lisa Zane (ARTICLE)
- [Rich Mironov knows how to build products that your customers will actually use \(and shares his expertise with you\)](#) by Dottie Schrock
- [9 Product Prioritization Frameworks for Product Managers](#) by Roadmunk (ARTICLE)

Job Transitions, Interviewing, and Resumes

- [How to Write a Resume That Converts](#) by Linda Zhang (ARTICLE)
- [Win the Uber Product Management Case Study](#) by Product Gym (ARTICLE)
- [Interview Guides](#) by TryExponent
- [The Ultimate List of Product Manager Interview Questions](#) by Product School (ARTICLE)
- [Clearing the Product Management Case Study Round](#) by Sushant Kumar (ARTICLE)

Hiring

- [How to Hire a Product Manager](#) by Ken Norton (ARTICLE)
- [How to Hire Great Product Managers](#) by Jackie Bavaro (ARTICLE)
- [Find, Vet and Close the Best Product Managers](#) by Todd Jackson (ARTICLE)

Product Discovery

- [Little Bets](#) Peter Sims
- [Continuous Discovery Habits](#) by Teresa Torres
- [Jobs to be Done: A Roadmap for Customer-Centered Innovation](#) by Stephen Wunker
- [The Mom Test](#) by Rob Fitzpatrick
- [Just Enough Research](#) by Erika Hall
- [A More Beautiful Question: The Power of Inquiry to Spark Breakthrough Ideas](#) by Warren Berger
- [Alchemy: The Surprising Power of Ideas That Don't Make Sense](#) by Rory Sutherland
- [Why Are Customers So Hard to Understand?](#) by Linda Zhang (ARTICLE)
- [Product Discovery Basics: All You Need to Know](#) by Teresa Torres (ARTICLE)

Problem Finding/Finding Meaningful Problems to Solve

- [Are Your Lights On](#) by Donald C. Gause and Gerald M. Weinberg
- [The Challenge Mindset: Find Purpose and Impact](#) Ted Talk by JP Michel
- [21 Lessons for the 21st Century](#) by Yuval Noah Harari
- [The Uninhabitable Earth](#) by David Wallace-Wells
- [Bill Gates Wants You to Help Solve These 10 Big Challenges](#) by Inc. (ARTICLE)
- [Are You Solving the Right Problem?](#) by HBR (ARTICLE)
- [Do we do enough problem-finding before problem solving?](#) By UX Collective (ARTICLE)

Product Strategy

- [Understanding: The Essential Guide to Competition and Strategy](#) by Michael Porter
- [7 Powers: The Foundations of Business Strategy](#) by Hamilton Helmer
- [Competing Against Luck](#) by Clayton M Christensen
- [Strategy of Excellence for Product Managers](#) by Greg Cohen
- [Playing to Win: How Strategy Really Works](#) by A.G. Lafley and Roger L. Martin
- [Good Strategy/Bad Strategy: The Difference and Why It Matters](#) by Richard Rumelt
- [Escaping the Build Trap: How Effective Product Management Creates Real Value](#) by Melissa Perri
- [Product Roadmaps Relunched](#) by Todd Lombardo
- [Build What Matters: Delivering Key Outcomes with Vision-Led Product Management](#) by Ben Foster and Rajesh Nerlikar
- [Lean Customer Development](#) by Cindy Alvarez
- [Landing Over Launching: What Product Managers Can Learn from Space Explorations](#) by Saujanya Shrivastava (ARTICLE)
- [Guide to Launching a New Product](#) by Linda Zhang (ARTICLE)
- [How to Define Your Product Strategy](#) by Gibson Biddle
- [A Practical Guide for Product Strategy](#) by Franco Fagioli
- [To Build Great Products, Build This Strong, Scalable System First](#) by First Round Review (ARTICLE)

Product Design

- [The Design of Everyday Things](#) by Don Norman
- [Designing for People](#) by Henry Dreyfuss
- [1000 Things Every Designer Needs to Know About People](#) by Susan Weinschenk

- [Hooked](#) by Nir Eyal
- [The Laws of Simplicity](#) by John Maeda
- [Don't Make Me Think](#) by Steve Krug
- [Inclusive Design for a Digital World](#) by Regine M. Gilbert
- [User Friendly: How the Hidden Rules of Design Are Changing the Way We Live, Work, and Play](#) by Cliff Kuang and Robert Fabricant
- [Cat Noone on designing for accessibility and inclusion](#) by Invision (ARTICLE)
- [Well Designed](#) by Jon Kolko
- [Digital Behaviour Design](#) by T. Dalton Combs and Ramsay A. Brown
- [Principles of Calm Technology](#) (ARTICLE)

People

- [Team Topologies](#) by Matthew Skelton and Manuel Pais
- [Tribes: We Need You to Lead Us](#) by Seth Godin
- [Legacy](#) by James Kerr
- [Radical Candor](#) by Kim Scott
- [Brave New Work](#) by Aaron Dignan
- [Peopware: Productive Projects and Teams](#) by Tom DeMarco
- [Practical Empathy for Collaboration and Creativity in Your Work](#) by Indi Young
- [The Culture Code: The Secrets of Highly Successful Groups](#) by Daniel Coyle
- [Adrenaline Junkies and Template Zombies](#) by Tom Demarco
- [The Right Way to Ask for Additional Resources](#) by Noa Ganot (ARTICLE)
- [How To Turn Self-Doubt Into Your #1 Product Management Skill](#) by Andrew Quan

Measuring Success

- [Measure What Matters](#) by John Doerr
- [Outcomes Over Output](#) by Joshua Seiden
- <https://future.a16z.com/north-star-metrics/> by Lenny Rachitsky (ARTICLE)

Growth

- [Crossing the Chasm](#) by Geoffrey A. Moore
- [Product-Led Growth: How to Build a Product That Sells Itself](#) by Wes Bush
- [Play Bigger](#) by Al Ramadan
- [How the Biggest Consumer Apps Got Their First 1000 Users](#) by Lenny Rachitsky (ARTICLE)

Product/General Leadership

- [Empowered: Ordinary People, Extraordinary Products](#) by Marty Cagan and Chris Jones
- [Product Manager: Coaching Tools- The Plan](#) by Marty Cagan (ARTICLE)
- [Value Proposition Design](#) by Alex Osterwalder, Yves Pigneur, Greg Bernarda, Alan Smith
- [Groundwork: Get Better at Making Better Products](#) by Vidya Dinamani
- [The Score Takes Care of Itself](#) by Bill Walsh
- [Product leadership: How Top Product Managers Launch Awesome Products and Build Successful Teams](#) by Richard Banfield
- [Dare to Lead](#) by Brene Brown
- [The Motive](#) by Patrick Lencioni
- [What Got You Here Won't Get You There](#) by Marshall Goldsmith
- [The Making of a Manager](#) by Julie Zhuo
- [What You Do is Who You Are](#) by Ben Horowitz
- [Leaders Eat Last](#) by Simon Sinek
- [Leading Meetings That People Actually Look Forward To](#) by Lisa Zane (ARTICLE)
- [What World Class Product Management Teams Do Differently](#) by Andres Phillips (ARTICLE)

Communication and Storytelling

- [Why Are We Yelling? The Art of Productive Disagreement](#) by Buster Benson
- [Articulating Design Decisions: Communicate with Stakeholders, Keep Your Sanity, and Deliver the Best User Experience](#) by Tom Greever
- [Resonate](#) by Nancy Duarte
- [Save the Cat!](#) By Blake Snyder
- [The Charisma Myth](#) by Olivia Fox Cabane
- [Joseph Campbell's The Hero's Journey](#) by Masterclass

Thinking/Problem Solving/Decision Making

- [An Astronaut's Guide to Life on Earth](#) by Chris Hadfield
- [Nudge](#) by Richard Thaler and Cass Sunstein
- [Thinking Fast and Slow](#) by Daniel Kahneman
- [The Art of Thinking Clearly](#) by Rolf Dobelli
- [Super Thinking](#) by Gabriel Weinberg and Lauren McCann McCann

- [Predictably Irrational](#) by Dan Ariely
- [Thinking in Systems](#) by Donella Meadows
- [Bill Gates: These are the 2 questions I use to tackle every big problem](#) by CNBC (ARTICLE)

Analyzing Data

- [Naked Statistics](#) by Charles Wheelan
- [Cartoon Guide to Statistics](#) by Larry Gonick
- [Storytelling with Data: A Data Visualization Guide for Business Professionals](#) by Cole Nussbaumer Knaflic
- [Asking Better Questions](#) by John Cutler (ARTICLE)

Productivity

- [The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People](#) by Stephen R. Covey
- [Atomic Habits](#) by James Clear
- [Indistractable](#) by Nir Eyal

Finance

- [Financial Intelligence](#) by Karen Berman
- [How Finance Works](#) by Mihir Desai
- [Monetizing Innovation](#) by Madhavan Ramanujam

Entrepreneurship/Startups/Business

- [The Lean Startup](#) by Eric Ries
- [The Hard Thing About Hard Things](#) by Ben Horowitz
- [Zero to One](#) by Peter Thiel
- [Product Hunt's List of Startup Books](#)
- [The Complete Guide to Bootstrapping Your Startup](#) by Jotform

Real-World Stories

- [Working Backwards: Insights, Stories, and Secrets from Inside Amazon](#) by Colin Bryar and Bill Carr
- [Shoe Dog](#) by Phil Knight

- [The Four: The Hidden DNA of Amazon, Apple, Facebook, and Google](#) by Scott Galloway
- [How Google Works](#) by Eric Schmidt and Jonathan Rosenberg

Inclusion and Belonging

- [Inclusive Growth: Future-proof your business by creating a diverse workplace](#) by Toby Mildon
- [How to Be an Inclusive Leader: Your Role in Creating Cultures of Belonging Where Everyone Can Thrive](#) by Jennifer Brown
- [Authentic Inclusion Drives Disruptive Innovation](#) by Frances West
- [The Leader's Guide to Unconscious Bias](#) by Pamela Fuller
- [Blindspot: Hidden Biases of Good People](#) by Mahzarin R. Banaji
- [Haben: The Deafblind Woman Who Conquered Harvard Law](#) by Haben Girma

Life Design

- [Designing Your Life](#) by Bill Burnett and Dave Evans
- [Designing Your Work Life](#) by Bill Burnett and Dave Evans
- [Start with Why](#) by Simon Sinek
- [Principles: Life and Work](#) by Ray Dalio
- [Tribe of Mentors](#) by Timothy Ferriss
- [Tools of Titans](#) by Timothy Ferriss
- [Think and Grow Rich](#) by Napoleon Hill
- [The 4-hour Workweek](#) by Timothy Ferriss
- [The \\$100 Startup](#) by Chris Guillebeau
- [Flow](#) by Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi

Foundational Soulwork

- [The Monk Who Sold His Ferrari](#) by Robin Sharma
- [Who Will Cry When You Die?](#) by Robin Sharma
- [The Four Agreements](#) by Miguel Ruiz
- [Untethered Soul](#) by Michael A. Singer
- [Ego is the Enemy](#) by Ryan Holiday
- [The Obstacle is the Way](#) by Ryan Holiday
- [The Subtle Art of Not Giving a F*ck](#) by Mark Manson
- [Daring Greatly](#) by Brene Brown

- [Rising Strong](#) by Brene Brown
- [You Are A Badass](#) by Jen Sincero
- [Untamed](#) by Glennon Doyle



Blogs/Newsletters/People to Follow

- [Bring the Donuts](#)
- [Silicon Valley Product Group](#)
- [Shreyas Doshi's Twitter Thread](#)
- [Product Lessons](#) by Linda Zhang (startup PM (Snapchat, Faire) and Solopreneur, creator of [Product Toolkit](#))
- [Product Life](#) by Will Lawrence (Product Manager, Facebook)
- [Product Manager HQ](#)
- [The Product Coalition](#)
- [Lenny Rachitsky](#)
- [Mind the Product](#)
- [Product Talk](#) by Teresa Torres
- [Bosky Mukherjee](#)
- [Diego Granados](#)
- [Becca Camp](#)
- [First Round Review](#)
- [Product Collective](#)
- [Folding Burritos](#)
- [Stratechery](#)
- [Gibson Biddle](#)
- [Advancing Women in Product](#)
- [Design Thinking](#)
- [Interaction Design Foundation](#)



Social Groups and Communities

- [Product Hunt](#)
- [Mind the Product Slack Group](#)
- [Product Managers Facebook Group](#)
- [Women in Product Facebook Group](#)
- [The Product Coalition](#)
- [HH Product Management](#)

Tools

[Author's Note: I have curated this list - it is not exhaustive and IMHO these are some of the best tools to start with; I have not yet found a great roadmapping tool that checks all of my boxes. As [Ken Norton says](#), "The tools don't matter". If you have any suggestions please [submit them here](#).]

Project Management

- [Jira](#)
- [Asana](#)
- [Smartsheet](#)

Prototyping

- [Figma](#)
- [Invision](#)

Collaboration

- [Slack](#)
- [Miro](#)
- [Trello](#)
- [Discord](#)
- [Google Docs](#)
- [Asana](#)
- [Basecamp](#)

A/B Testing and Website Analytics

- [Google Analytics](#)
- [Google Optimize](#)
- [Optimizely](#)
- [Hotjar](#)
- [Lucky Orange](#)
- [Crazy Egg](#)
- [Heap](#)
- [Mixpanel](#)

No Code Tools

- [Makerpad](#)
- [Adalo](#)
- [Airtable](#)
- [Bubble](#)
- [Webflow](#)
- [Coda.io](#)

Accessibility

- [Web Content Accessibility Guidelines](#)
- [Web Accessibility Initiative](#)
- [Accessibility Insights for Web](#)
- [Stark Accessibility Tools](#)
- [Webaim Contrast Checker](#)
- [Adobe Contrast Analyzer](#)

Sharing Notes

- [Notion](#)
- [Confluence](#)



Job Finding

- https://topstartups.io/?&utm_source=newsletter_2021-10-03
- [LinkedIn Jobs](#)
- [Product Hunt Jobs](#)
- [Women in Product Jobs](#)



Salary Insights

- [Levels.fyi](#)
- [Glassdoor](#)
- [2020 Female Salaries in Tech](#)
- [81 Cents](#)
- [Product Management Trends and Benchmarks Report 2021](#)

- [Salary Info - Product Manager Global Salaries 2017](#)
- [PM Compensation Responses \(2017\)](#)
- [How I negotiated \\$375K Facebook PM offer](#) (ARTICLE)



Bootcamps

- [AltMBA](#)
- [Co.Lab](#)
- [PM Dojo](#)
- [Product School](#)
- [Brainstation](#)



Associate PM Programs

- [APM List](#)
- [The Best Associate Product Manager Programs 2021](#)
- [Google APM Program](#)
- [Uber APM Program](#)
- [Facebook RPM Program](#)
- [Twitter APM Program](#)
- [LinkedIn APM Program](#)
- [Lyft APM Program](#)
- [Yahoo APM Program](#)
- [Salesforce APM Program](#)
- [Atlassian APM Program](#)
- [KP Fellows Program](#)



Coaching

- [Ken Norton Coaching](#)
- [SVPG Coaching](#)
- [Prodify](#)
- [Product People](#)
- [Exponent](#)
- [Lisa Zane](#)
- [Joni Hoadley](#)
- [Christian Strunk](#)
- [Blair Presley](#)

- [Adam Thomas](#)
- [Petra Wille](#)
- [Matt Yubas](#)

Templates

<https://www.facebook.com/groups/womeninproduct/posts/1247026375715368>

[Author's Note: I have curated this list - it is not exhaustive and IMHO templates should be used for reference as a starting point. To do your job well as a PM you need to really understand your audience, business objectives, product strategy, ways in which your stakeholders work, and the way your business functions, and other relevant constraints and inputs. Documentation that you create should be adapted to meet YOUR specific objectives and YOUR specific needs. i.e. If you are creating a document specifically for an engineering team, you can speak with them and ask them what format they prefer. Understanding not only your own objectives but also your stakeholders' needs can help to inform how detailed your documentation is, and how it is formatted and framed. If you have any template suggestions please [submit them here](#).]

- [An Actionable Guide to Product Roadmaps \(with templates\)](#) by Will Lawrence/Product Life
- [My Favourite Product Management Templates](#) by Lenny Rachitsky
- [Atlassian Templates](#)
- [Product Brief Template](#) by Michelle Lee
- [Product Templates](#) by Christian Strunk
- [How I Lead Product Reviews](#) by Will Lawrence/Product Life
- [MVP Template](#) by Clearbridge Mobile

If you have relevant resources to suggest [please add them here](#).

Did you find this resource list valuable?

Would you rate it a 10/10? If not, why?

Please let me know [here](#).

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